

QUICK GUIDE · HEALTHCARE ASSISTANCE

Free & Low-Cost Dental Care

Dental work is expensive and most insurance leaves big gaps — but there is real free and low-cost care if you know where to look. Below are the most trusted national programs. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Watch out for advertised “dental grants” that still leave you with a big bill. The programs below are nonprofits, dental schools, and government services — not sales pitches. A real program never charges a fee just to apply.

1 Find Free & Low-Cost Clinics Near You

National directories listing community clinics, sliding-scale dentists, and low-cost programs by location.

☐ NeedyMeds — Free & Low-Cost Clinics

A national directory of free and reduced-cost dental clinics. Search by location.

→ www.needymeds.org/free-clinics

☐ Health Center Finder — HRSA

Federally funded health centers offer dental care on a sliding fee scale based on income.

→ findahealthcenter.hrsa.gov

☐ FindHelp.org — Dental Search

Enter your ZIP code and search “dental” for local free or low-cost care.

→ www.findhelp.org

2 Volunteer Dentists Through Dental Lifeline

A national network connecting volunteer dentists with people who qualify — often for free comprehensive treatment.

☐ Dental Lifeline Network — Donated Dental Services

Free treatment for people who are elderly, have a disability, or are medically fragile. Check your state program and eligibility.

→ dentallifeline.org/our-state-programs

3 Dental Schools — Low-Cost, Supervised Care

Dental and hygiene schools offer treatment at a fraction of the usual cost, done by students under expert supervision.

☐ Dental Schools — ADA Directory

Find accredited dental schools that run low-cost clinics open to the public.

→ www.ada.org

☐ Dental Hygiene Programs — ADHA

Hygiene schools offer very low-cost cleanings, X-rays, and preventive care.

→ www.adha.org

4 Government & Public Coverage

Public programs cover dental care for many adults and children — worth checking even if you think you don't qualify.

☐ Medicaid & CHIP Dental Benefits

Children always get dental coverage; many states cover adults too.

→ www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/benefits/dental-care

☐ InsureKidsNow — Find a Dentist

A federal tool to find dentists who accept Medicaid and CHIP for children.

→ www.insurekidsnow.gov

☐ Eldercare Locator — For Seniors

Connects you with local agencies that may offer dental help and referrals.

→ eldercare.acl.gov or call 1-800-677-1110

5 Special Situations

Targeted programs for children, survivors of violence, and veterans.

☐ America's ToothFairy — Kids' Dental Care

Connects families with free and low-cost dental care for children.

→ www.americastoothfairy.org

☐ Give Back a Smile — Survivors of Violence

Free restorative dental care for survivors of domestic and sexual violence.

→ aacdcharitablefoundation.org

☐ VA Dental Care — For Veterans

Eligible veterans get VA dental benefits; others may use the VA Dental Insurance Program.

→ www.va.gov/health-care/about-va-health-benefits/dental-care

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Avoid "dental grant" offers that ask for money up front. Real programs don't charge you to apply. Stick to .gov, .org, dental schools, and the directories above.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Call more than one program. Funding and waiting lists change constantly — if one says no, the next may say yes. Keep a simple list of who you called and what they said.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers the main national programs. For dental help specific to your city, county, or ZIP code, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options and walk you through applying.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
